of rocket propulsion were at least five years away.

However, it did not take me long to shelve the disappointment of Diamont BC Stage IV. After al , I had thoroughly enjoyed working on this project. In time, RATO fil ed the vacuum created in me by the Diamont BC Stage.

When the RATO project was underway, the SLV project slowly started taking shape. Competence for al major systems of a launch vehicle had been established in Thumba by now. Through their outstanding efforts, Vasant Gowarikar, MR Kurup and Muthunayagam prepared TERLS for a big leap in rocketry.

Prof. Sarabhai was an exemplar in the art of team-building. On one occasion, he had to identify a person who could be given the responsibility for developing a telecommand system for the SLV. Two men were competent to carry out this task—one was the seasoned and sophisticated UR Rao and the other was a relatively unknown experimenter, G Madhavan Nair. Although I was deeply impressed by Madhavan Nair’s dedication and abilities, I did not rate his chances as very good. During one of Prof. Sarabhai’s routine visits, Madhavan Nair boldly demonstrated